YAHOO AXIS

Trying to revive their web presence, Yahoo launched a brand new web browser for iOS devices called Yahoo Axis. It provides an intuitive, visual way to find what you need, as quickly as possible, and syncs your content across the iPhone, iPad or iPod touch. On the desktop, Yahoo Axis is available as a browser plugin. http://dgit.in/JqOXeJ

MORE SPACE FOR FREE!

Dropbox recently compiled a list of ways in which a user can get free space, upto 22GB! Tasks include inviting friends, using Camera Upload to upload pictures from a mobile phone or camera, among other things. Check out Dropquest 2012 whose winner gets 1GB free space. http://dgit.in/LcMzWE

GOOGLE+ MOBILE APPS GET AN OVERHAUL

Google+ app has got an iOS and Android app update. The new version brings a new UI and better navigation. In addition, the Android app now lets you start a Hangout apart from just joining one already on as in the old version. http://dgit.in/KWXrp4

BUMP TO TRANSFER PHOTOS

Among the many ways to transfer

photos, here is quite a novel one. Bump's new app for Android and iOS requires you to 'bump' the device against the computer's spacebar. It then lets you download them to your hard disk or create a shareable link. Easy peasy! http://dgit.in/Juimjh

RAM, or simply re-branded K10s (the upcoming Kepler-powered Tesla GCGPU).

Not only will the GeForce Grid be more efficient, but Nvidia is also claiming that its new system will register a huge drop in latency over existing cloud gaming installations. Take a look at the graph to the right: Yes, Kepler is so powerful that the GeForce

Grid will be a hair faster than your Xbox + TV. Keep your eye on the Kool-Aid, though: While Kepler's hardware H.264 encoder will certainly help things along, the "Game Pipeline" and "Network" improvements are peppered with caveats.

For a start, the huge reduction in game pipeline processing will only be realized if software developers actually design their games "specifically for the awesome graphics processing power that these cloud machines deliver." As it stands, game developers really don't care if an engine takes 5ms to render a frame or 15ms — it's all the same, on a local console or PC — but when we make the jump to cloud gaming, every millisecond counts. In a day and age where games are riddled with small, latency-inducing bugs, Nvidia is too optimistic on this front.

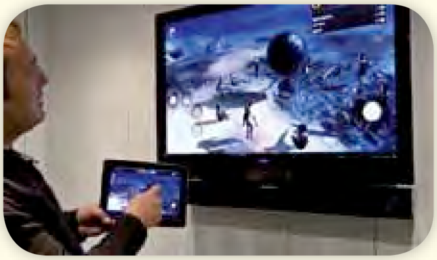
Then there's network performance. Basically, it seems like Nvidia's solution is to install so many GeForce Grid data centers that network latency never accounts for more than 10ms — either that, or it wants to roll out its own fiber infrastructure. Neither of these things are likely to happen in the near term. Nvidia has the right idea with GeForce Grid, but it's simply five years too soon.

Despite my misgivings, though, cloud gaming does have promise. Worldwide roll outs are now so rapid that in five or 10 years, a large percentage of the developed world will have fiber to the home or cabinet. It will take time, but with enough pressure from console makers and publishers, developers will eventually fine-tune their game engines, too.

What then? What will happen when there is no logical reason to keep a console in your living room? With the PS4, Xbox 720, and Wii U all coming down the line, cloud gaming isn't going to take off in the near term — but what about the next generation of consoles?

It is entirely possible that the Xbox 1080 will simply be a dumb little box, with four gamepad sockets on the front, and HDMI and power on the back; it could even be built into a Microsoft TV. Microsoft already has a huge cloud presence, too — and really, streaming games isn't all that different from streaming movies.

The appeal of cloud gaming to companies such as Microsoft and Sony is immense. In an instant, short of breaking into the local data center, software piracy goes out the window. With the expensive console out of



the way, their pool of prospective gamers (and customers) immediately swells. By default, the Xbox 1080 service might be completely free — but just like today's free-to-play games, Microsoft could charge you for additional levels and in-game items, as well as the ability to connect multiple gamepads, output at higher resolution, unlock higher framerates, and so on.

Cloud gaming is completely cross-platform, too: There's no functional difference between a PC monitor, TV, smartphone, or tablet. Imagine being able to pause a game at home, and then continue it on your tablet or office computer. Imagine multiplayer games where you're in front of the TV, but your friend is on the other side of the world, playing from a Facebook window on his laptop.

The flip side, of course, is that Microsoft (or EA) could charge you for excessive use ("you have exceeded our fair-use policy...") — and what happens if you get banned? Do you lose access to all of the games you've purchased? Will you have the option of storing saved games locally, or will they all be in the cloud?

Ultimately, though, in much the same way that cloud computing and storage has exploded in the last few years, cloud gaming will follow suit. Cloud gaming, like cloud computing, digital downloads, and streaming video, simply has too many benefits to ignore.